

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦K

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠J

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣10

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 5
♥ 8 6 5
♦ Q J 9 8 7
♣ K J

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q J 9 7 3 2

♦ 5

♣ 8 6 4



♠ K 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 10 3 2

♣ A Q 10 5 3 2

♠ A J 10 6 4 3

♥ A

♦ A K 6 4

♣ 9 7

Here SOUTH has the kind of hand you need to raise a preempt to game.

SOUTH assumes that NORTH has a hand with six winners in it. He can provide four more, so that is just enough for game. He bids 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♠K

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 4
♥ K J 5
♦ 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 7 2

♠ 10 3
♥ 8 7 4
♦ Q J 10 8 6
♣ A 10 4



♠ A Q J 9 7 6 5
♥ Q 10 2
♦ 7
♣ 6 3

♠ 8 2
♥ A 9 6 3
♦ A K 5 3
♣ 9 8 5

EAST has a 7-card ♠ suit but he is too strong to open with a preemptive bid. So he opens 1 ♠ instead.

WEST should respond 2 ♣, and EAST can do nothing but rebid the ♠ suit.

WEST thinks there should be game and bids 4 ♠

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
4 ♠			
All Pass			
4 ♠ by East			
Lead: ♦ K			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 10 9 5 3 2

♥ 8 2

♦ 9 4 3

♣ A 6

♠ K Q

♥ Q J

♦ A K Q 6 5

♣ K J 4 2



♠ A 8

♥ 10 6 5

♦ J 10 8

♣ 10 9 8 7 3

♠ 7 6 4

♥ A K 9 7 4 3

♦ 7 2

♣ Q 5

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠ J

SOUTH is too weak to open 1♥ but just right for 2♥.

Wow! NORTH has 21 HCP and two good ♥s. Could this be time for a slam try?

Nope, no slam here. Suppose SOUTH has six ♥s headed by the AK. The trump suit would certainly be solid, but then SOUTH couldn't possibly have an outside Ace as well or he would have been too strong for a Weak-two opening. So NORTH just bids 4♥.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 8 3
♥ K Q J 7 6 2
♦ 8 5
♣ 8 5

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 10 9 8 3
♦ A 10 3
♣ 10 3



♠ A Q 5
♥ 4
♦ K Q 9 4
♣ K J 7 4 2

♠ K 6 4 2
♥ 5
♦ J 7 6 2
♣ A Q 9 6

West	North	East	South
2♥			
All Pass			
2♥ by West			
Lead: ♣10			

EAST really hates that 2♥ opening by WEST.

But there's no sense bidding and probably making matters worse, so she grits her teeth and passes.

If you think 3NT has a chance you are delusional.